

MNENA Social Media Guide

Welcome, Neighborhood Changemakers!

Welcome to the Marshall New Era Neighborhood Association Social Media Playbook—a community-crafted guide just for you, our dedicated volunteer storytellers! By spotlighting real residents, sharing upcoming events, and celebrating everyday life in midtown Sacramento, you're not just posting—you're **owning our narrative** and bringing neighbors together.

We know you're volunteers with busy lives, so let's start **small and steady**: set a goal of just **two posts a week**, plus occasional Instagram Stories reminders. This consistent, clear communication is all you need to begin increasing awareness and connection.

Social media isn't about perfection—it's about **clear, caring communication** that builds trust and invites participation.

Goals

1. **Increase awareness** of the association and its mission
2. **Promote events and initiatives**
(e.g., monthly meetings, clean-ups, NNO, Halloween Party, Farmers Market Booth, etc)
3. **Encourage volunteer participation**
4. **Celebrate community pride**
5. **Share important updates and alerts**

Target Audience

Only 3% of neighborhood are paid members (mostly homeowners) — need to expand reach to **renters**, especially those who are newer or less aware of the association

- **Tenure**: Longtime and new renters & homeowners
- **Demographics**: Our neighbors are diverse in every sense of the word

Primary Channels

- **Instagram** – visual storytelling, short captions, stories, reels
- **Facebook** – events, longer-form updates, broader neighborhood reach



Content Categories

Category	Description	Example Post
Event Announcements	Highlight upcoming neighborhood events such as meetings, clean-ups, parties, or booths.	“🎃 Save the date! Our Halloween Party is Oct 27 at Marshall School!”
Event Recaps	Share photos and outcomes from past events to build community and encourage attendance.	“Thanks to the 30+ neighbors who showed up to clean Sutter’s Landing last Saturday!”
Calls to Action (so far in newsletter)	Requests for help, involvement, or attendance—fosters a sense of ownership.	“We need 4 volunteers for the Farmers Market Booth this Sunday—can you help?”
Updates & Alerts (nice to have)	Share time-sensitive news like road closures, safety alerts, policy updates, etc.	“⚠️ E Street will be closed for tree trimming on June 10 from 9AM–4PM.”
Reminders (Stories)	Remind people via stories—short, timely nudges for events or deadlines.	“Story: Don’t forget—Tonight’s neighborhood meeting at 6PM! 📅”
Behind-the-Scenes (nice to have)	Casual, fun look into what the board or volunteers are doing to make things happen.	“Printing flyers for Neighbors Night Out!”
Neighborhood History & Pride (leverage board history)	Share interesting facts, historic photos, or prideful stories about the community.	“📷 This photo shows the corner of Marshall & D St in 1978—recognize anything?”
Community Spotlights (nice to have)	Highlight people, local businesses, artists, or board members to strengthen connection.	“Meet Sandra—a talented baker who volunteers every month!”
User-Generated Content (Re-share posts)	Reshare neighbor-submitted photos or quotes with permission to build trust and participation.	“Thanks @sacmidtownmom for this great shot of the market crowd last weekend!”

Content Principles

- **Approachable and neighborly tone**
- Celebrate **rental and homeowner stories equally**
- Always include:
 - A clear hook in the first sentence
 - Call to action (CTA), like “Save the date!” or “Tag a neighbor who should see this”
 - Emojis to increase scannability (if appropriate)
 - Tag partners or contributors

Content Guidelines

- **Images:** Use high-quality images or Canva templates with neighborhood-friendly color
- **Hashtags:** #NewEraNeighbors #SacramentoLiving #MidtownPride (you can brainstorm a branded hashtag)
- **Timing:**
 - **Instagram:** Post between 10AM–2PM or 5–7PM
 - **Facebook:** Evenings or lunch hours (12–1PM, 6–8PM)
- **Stories:** Use for reminders and real-time event updates

How Volunteers Should Use This Guide

Understand Your Role & Tools

- All volunteers will have **access to Canva templates**, along with the final calendar and captions guide.
- You're empowered to **select and post** two times per week (Tuesdays & Saturdays), plus occasional **Instagram Stories reminders**.
- **No design experience required**—just drag, drop, edit text, and stick to the Canva templates provided. This keeps us on brand

Steps to make a post

1. **Choose the appropriate content category from the table above.**
Event Announcements, Event Recaps, Reminders (Stories), etc.
2. **Log into Canva** and find the appropriate template
3. **Make a copy** and start creating a new, compelling graphic that is on-brand
4. **Start Editing**
 - a. Add just the essential details to the graphic (who, what, when, where)
 - b. Drop in images if needed

- c. If the canva template is recurring, consider shuffling the brand colors to keep it fresh
 - d. Add some flair - each post graphic can have up to two illustrations / icons
- 5. **Write a short caption:**
 - Hook** (“🎃 Don’t miss the Halloween Party!”),
 - Body** (where and what’s happening),
 - CTA** (“RSVP via link in bio!”).
- 6. **Schedule or post immediately** on Tuesday or Saturday around midday—no need to overthink it.
- 7. **Stay connected**—check comments or messages for 5–10 minutes afterward and revisit at an interval that makes sense for that content type.

Every post grows our voice and sense of belonging. Over time, we’ll build momentum—and may even expand platforms or post frequency. For now, clarity and consistency are your superpowers.

Together, with a few minutes and a Canva click, you’ll help every renter and homeowner feel seen, heard, and part of something special. Let’s make our community shine—one post at a time! ✨